

Name of Committee: Devotion School Building Committee

Meeting Date: 11 July 2014 Time: 8:00 a.m. Meeting Location: Town Hall, Room 103

Attendees: See attached sign-in sheets.

Next Meetings: All commence at 8:00 a.m. are July 25 Town Hall Room 103, August 8 Town Hall Room 111, August 22 TH Room 103 and September 5, 2014 TH Room 103.

Topic: Meeting Minutes

H. Charlupski moved approval of the Meeting Minutes of May 2, 2014 and May 30, 2014. Second by A. Cox and A. Hyatt, respectively.

Meeting minutes of May 2, 2014 and May 30, 2014 unanimously approved with P. Roberts abstaining on May 30 minutes.

Topic: Project Update

T. Guigli reported on the Facility Assessment Subcommittee (FAS) meeting at the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) on 7.9.2014. Unfortunately, approval of the Educational Program/Template was not secured. The MSBA maintains that the case has not yet been completely made by the Town of Brookline as to the need for the Multi- Purpose Room in the educational program.

B. Lupini stated there are two decision points; allowing the Multi-Purpose Room and MSBA financial participation in its cost if it is allowed. It has been confirmed that currently the MSBA does not include such spaces in elementary, middle or K-8 schools. It is also thought that the Multi-Purpose Room may be more readily accepted in an additions/renovations option since the space already exists and may be of a smaller grossing factor, but that is not confirmed.

A discussion about the utility and use of the Multi-Purpose Room then took place. Questions were asked about what benefit would be obtained by removing the interstitial floor, flexibility given the size of the space, sight lines, etc. S. Modigliani stated that if the Multi-Purpose Room is not allowed in the program for Option 3.2, then it effectively eliminates this option from further consideration, since the space is considered by the TOB to be essential to the educational program. He stated his opinion that this option offers certain benefits to the project not available with the addition/renovations options including lower cost, little or no relocation of students, more compact program and more rapid move-in. All parties agree that finalization of the educational program with the MSBA as soon as possible is essential.

T. Guigli noted that he will be working with the architect and school staff in the coming days to get additional information to the MSBA on the scheduling and use of common spaces in the proposed design in an effort to secure approval of the educational program/template as soon as possible. In other update news, he reported the first draft of

the CM at Risk RFQ has been completed and is under review.

Topic: Schedule Update

T. Guigli confirmed that the schedule attached to the minutes of May 30, 2014 with a run date of May 28, 2014 is the current and latest schedule. It will be forwarded to the MSBA to satisfy their request for an updated schedule. Among other things, it calls for at least one community meeting in September and for selection of the “preferred option” at the end of September.

G. Metzger stated that this latest schedule is in jeopardy based on the fact that the educational program/template is not approved and design progress has been on hold for two months.

Topic: Decision Making Process

Selectman DeWitt distributed two documents (attached) “Characteristics of Options” and “Rubric for evaluation design options” and reviewed them with the Building Committee. She stated that for any and all designs, the assumption is that the educational program is fully met, therefore the intent is that the options will be assessed on other criteria. When asked whether all options in the Preliminary Design Program (PDP) submission must be developed, G. Metzger stated that each must be developed to a level and to a points that one or more of them are not worth pursuing further. For example, one or more of the additions/renovations options may be “collapsed” into another one of the additions/renovations options if they are so similar to each other.

G. Metzger then reviewed the four options with the Committee with respect to open space and active play areas, summarizing as follows:

Option 1.1 currently includes more emphasis on active play fields on Harvard Street.

Option 1.4 currently does not include active play fields on Harvard Street.

Option 2 is similar to 1.1 but can be re-programmed to move active play areas to rear of site

Option 3.2 currently includes active play spaces between the footprint of the proposed building and the existing Devotion House.

Active play fields are loosely defined as those that would require a protective enclosure for errant balls as opposed to for aiding in management of children on site. G. Metzger stated there is varying amounts of flexibility in the characterization of the options above as will be revealed and explored when the designs are further developed in the coming weeks. A discussion then took place as to providing the architect some input in said effort.

Ultimately it was the consensus of the Committee that there should be no active play fields directly abutting Harvard Street forward of the Devotion House.

Selectman DeWitt then briefly updated the Committee on the time table and process of the proposed Override vote.

Finally a discussion took place about the need for the architect to continue work on the project assuming that the Multi-Purpose Room will be included in the project but not funded by the MSBA. T. Guigli recommended that the architect proceed, noting that it is not without risk to the Town. The downside is that the Multi-Purpose Room is not included and that there are costs incurred to re-design. G. Metzger stated there is limited risk if the decision is received by the next Building Committee Meeting. The consensus of the Committee is that the architect proceed.

Meeting Adjourned at approximately 9:30 a.m.

Respectfully submitted,

Anthony Guigli
Owner's Project Manager